

Don't Just Work Hard, Work Smart: Wrap-Up, Featuring Marie Mouchet

Marie Mouchet, VP & CIO Colonial Pipeline Company

Pat Summitt was an expert strategist who knew how to chart the most intelligent path toward her goals. Pat said, "The blueprint is this: knowledge, confidence, relaxation, results. Knowledge builds confidence, which causes you to be relaxed, which gives you good results."

It is a simple, yet powerful approach, but only if the foundation is secure. Knowledge is the starting point and is crucial to effective leadership in professional settings.

In this module, we learned that success requires strategy and clear communication. Establish concrete goals for your staff and focus team energy on fulfilling specific expectations. Healthy team culture shares the responsibility for ensuring expectations are met.

Once the goals are clear, outline a coherent plan by prioritizing the order in which objectives are to be accomplished in order to pace your team's preparation for success. To execute your strategy, you have to bring balance to your own strengths and weaknesses. Stay open to feedback, especially feedback from your peers.

Next, apply the feedback by surrounding yourself with people who can complement your personality and offset your weaknesses. This frees you up to focus on your strengths and to lead through influence and example rather than fear and compliance. The more you know yourself, the better you'll be at prioritizing between problems. Choose your battles wisely so you can maintain focus on progressing toward your goal.

When you work smart, not only do you harness the power of your time and energy for maximum impact, you also help others find direction with their talents and abilities. Knowledge and understanding are the best tools for blending hard work with smart work so that you can get real results while staying focused, relaxed, and productive towards your goals.